

▶ TRIANGLES

Triangles form the basis of many patchwork units and, after squares and rectangles, are the next easiest and most versatile to work with. They can be combined with

other triangle units or with plain units to create a wide range of blocks. Triangle units also make a wonderful impact when used in sashings and borders.

MAKING A PAIR OF HALF-SQUARE TRIANGLES

While a half-square triangle, which is a square made of two right-angled triangles, can be made by sewing two triangles together, a faster way is to start with two squares and use the method below.



- 1 Cut two squares, each 2.2cm ($\frac{7}{8}$ in) larger than the desired finished size and place them right sides together, with the lighter colour on top.



- 2 Using a pencil, mark a diagonal line in one direction across the wrong side of the lighter-coloured square.



- 3 Pin, then machine stitch along each side of the marked line, stitching 6mm ($\frac{1}{4}$ in) from the line.



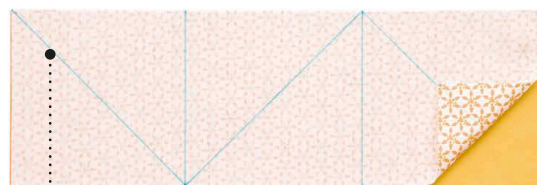
- 4 Using a rotary cutter or scissors, cut along the pencil line.



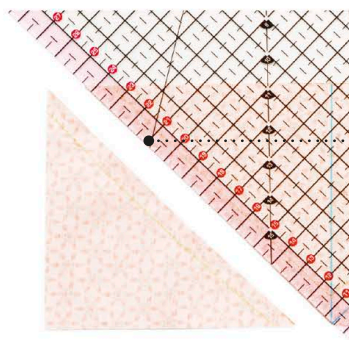
- 5 Open out the pieces of fabric and press the seams, usually towards the darker fabric, to make two identical half-square triangles.

Trim the "dog ear" points at each end of the seam

MAKING MULTIPLE HALF-SQUARE TRIANGLES FROM STRIPS



- 1 Start by cutting fabric strips that are the desired width plus 2.2cm ($\frac{7}{8}$ in). Place them right sides together and mark squares on the wrong side of the lighter fabric. Draw a diagonal line across each square, alternating the direction of the line in each square.



- 2 Sew a 6mm ($\frac{1}{4}$ in) seam on each side of the marked diagonal lines. Cut along the marked diagonal and vertical lines to separate the half-square triangles. Press the seams towards the darker fabric.